

Add the following code to the end of *settings.py*:

```
settings.py --snip--
# My settings.
LOGIN_REDIRECT_URL = 'learning_logs:index'
```

With all the default settings in *settings.py*, it's helpful to mark off the section where we're adding new settings. The first new setting we'll add is `LOGIN_REDIRECT_URL`, which tells Django which URL to redirect to after a successful login attempt.

Linking to the Login Page

Let's add the login link to *base.html* so it appears on every page. We don't want the link to display when the user is already logged in, so we nest it inside an `{% if %}` tag:

```
base.html <p>
    <a href="{% url 'learning_logs:index' %}">Learning Log</a> -
    <a href="{% url 'learning_logs:topics' %}">Topics</a> -
    ❶ {% if user.is_authenticated %}
    ❷     Hello, {{ user.username }}.
    {% else %}
    ❸     <a href="{% url 'accounts:login' %}">Log in</a>
    {% endif %}
</p>

{% block content %}{% endblock content %}
```

In Django's authentication system, every template has a `user` object available that always has an `is_authenticated` attribute set: the attribute is `True` if the user is logged in and `False` if they aren't. This attribute allows you to display one message to authenticated users and another to unauthenticated users.

Here we display a greeting to users currently logged in ❶. Authenticated users have an additional `username` attribute set, which we use to personalize the greeting and remind the user they're logged in ❷. For users who haven't been authenticated, we display a link to the login page ❸.

Using the Login Page

We've already set up a user account, so let's log in to see if the page works. Go to <http://localhost:8000/admin/>. If you're still logged in as an admin, look for a **logout** link in the header and click it.

When you're logged out, go to <http://localhost:8000/accounts/login/>. You should see a login page similar to the one shown in Figure 19-4. Enter the username and password you set up earlier, and you should be brought back to the home page. The header on the home page should display a greeting personalized with your username.